



Put in all the Basic Settings for the router

you want—it is what your wireless network will be called. You should leave all other settings the way they are.

Clicking on Wireless Security will take you to a page where you have to specify a security mode. Here you should use WPA Personal or WPA2 Personal, because you don't really need Enterprise level security, and WEP is not secure enough. Since all the devices on your network need to be capable of using the same security mode, we suggest you stick with WPA Personal here. If you use WPA2, your laptop(s) should have no trouble connecting, but devices such as smart phones or Sony PSP might not be able to connect. You will need to specify an 8-digit key that people will have to type to gain access to your WiFi network. Make it easy to remember, but complicated enough—at least one number and one uppercase letter.

You can add on security by allowing only certain devices to connect to your network, and ignoring all the rest. You can do this by enabling Wireless Mac Filtering, and then choosing whether you want the list to be a block list or allow list. Let's say you want to allow only certain devices to access the network; you will have to set the filter to "Permit only" and add in the MAC address of all the WiFi-enabled devices you own.

Security And Restrictions

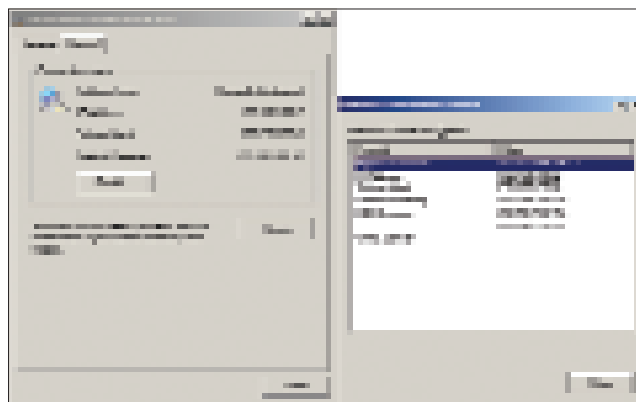
Clicking on Security will give you two options—Firewall and VPN. All you should do is make sure that all the boxes under Firewall are checked. Leave the VPN settings the way they are.

Under Access Restrictions, you can control who accesses what and when. You can define up to 10 access policies, which basically means you can make 10 rules here. Amongst other things, you can select a list of PCs, based on MAC addresses, IP addresses or IP ranges, and set times when they get access to the Internet, or times that they don't. All the settings are quite self-explanatory.

You can also block services such as trace route, ping, SSH, IRC, etc., from the router itself, making doubly sure that no one can use a protocol you don't want them to. Apart from all this you can even block sites by typing in their addresses, or you can block sites based on keywords. Blocking sites with the word "download" is a good idea if you are on a limited bandwidth account and have others using the same router.

Applications And Gaming

Under this header, you'll find options to let you tweak the way the router handles your online gaming requirements. For example, if you're addicted to *Quake III*, you can forward ports 27,000 to 29,000 to your desktop's IP address to make sure that all data sent by Q3 servers comes directly to you without any delay. Under Port Triggering, you can forward a set of ports to another port. Say for example you're hosting an FTP server on your PC, but instead of port 21, you're hosting it on port 2121. Most people who connect to your FTP server will never type



Find your LAN card's MAC address and get your router to spoof it

“:2121”, and will end up getting connection error messages. Using port triggering you can set the router to accept data on port 21 from the Net, and send them to your PC on port 2121.

DMZ stands for De-Militarized Zone. Basically, if you enable this setting, and point it to your Desktop, all packets that aren't specifically marked for others will come to you. Obviously, DMZ reduces security, so use it at your own risk.

Administration And Status

Under Administration, you will find options to change the admin password, and choose whether the Web server runs on various protocols or not—you could choose to only run it as HTTPS, making access to the control panel more secure.

Under Status, you will see a summary of all the settings you changed. It will inform you the status of your Net connection. You can choose to disengage or engage your Internet connection. Everything else is pretty self-explanatory.

Once you're done with all this, you're ready to start connecting WiFi-enabled gadgets to your network. Happy streaming! ■

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